

PEGGYSUESDINERCASEYEDIT

Hello and welcome to the new Travel Radio Australia. A bit of background, I've been a reporter for the program for the past 15 years or so, and the original host, Rens Veers, has now retired and is enjoying life travelling around the world from his base on the Gold Coast, Queensland, Australia. Well, he's graciously handed over the reins to myself, which is a huge honour.

Travel Radio Australia has a fantastic history, with thousands of contributors and segments being aired over the past 25 years. It's such a privilege to be chosen as the program's new host, and Travel Radio Australia will continue to bring you the best content from around the world. We thank Rens and all the other past contributing travel writers and journalists for being part of the Travel Radio Australia podcast.

Anyway, let's get started. I was in Los Angeles, USA recently, and decided to take a road trip via limousine to Las Vegas, Nevada, and, you know, record some stories along the way. We start our journey in Huntington Beach, California, then it's on the road to the fabulous Las Vegas, Nevada.

Later, we visit back in sunny Huntington Beach, Surf City, to visit a world-class beach volleyball contest. Our first stop on the way to Las Vegas was to an iconic 1950s themed diner called Peggy Sue's. Now, this place has an interesting history, and it's definitely worth a stop on the way from Los Angeles to Vegas.

I caught up with the son and current manager of Peggy Sue herself during the stop there. Travel Radio Australia, and we're here at this fantastic facility called Peggy Sue's Diner. It's a 50s diner, and I'm here with Casey, who is the son of Peggy Sue, and Casey, your mom started this whole place.

Tell us all about it. Sure. My parents, the diner, they bought the diner in 1987.

It's an original 50s diner built in 1954. They took their background of their love for music and movies and used that to inspire the theme of the restaurant. It is an amazing place.

As soon as you walk in, you're transported back into the real 50s here, aren't you, really? Yeah, and a lot of the memorabilia in here is stuff that my parents collected. They also, my mom grew up cooking with her grandmother, and they took all those recipes, and those are what inspired the menu for the diner. So, everything's still home-cooked here the way we like to make it and eat it.

And what was it like growing up here as a kid? It just would have been like a fairyland for you. Well, the diner, you know, it's evolved into what it is now. When it first opened, when they first got it, it only sat about 50 people, and through their hard work and dreams, they expanded it to what it is now, which is sort of a piece of Americana and a destination for people all over the world to come visit.

And we just try to maintain it and preserve the experience so that everybody gets to enjoy it. It's a beautiful, beautiful place. Some of the memorabilia you have here is priceless.

Tell us a bit about it. Yeah, well, I'd say one of the most unique and priceless items is a letter that Chuck Berry wrote to my mom years ago after he stopped by, just to thank her for having the restaurant and keeping the 50s alive, you know. Some of the other stuff, you know, the jukeboxes and the trinkets and everything, some have been donated by people.

Other things, it's just that we've acquired over time, you know. It's really, really unique. And how can people find you? You're on the highway here, and if you're coming to Vegas, you really can't miss it.

There's signs everywhere, and you just pull off and come in. Yeah, well, we don't do a lot of advertising beyond just the billboards that you see from here to Vegas. You know, through the years, we've tried to sort of strategically get space to people when they might be hungry to want to stop by and eat.

But, you know, we're in Yermo, California. We're 10 minutes outside Barstow and about halfway between Los Angeles and Las Vegas on your drive. And you're also very famous for having some equally famous people, apart from Chuck Berry, drop by.

Can you tell us about a few of them? Yeah, when the diner before, it's become sort of the mainstay that it is now. We used to have a lot of celebrities, people like one of my dad's favorite was Dick Van Dyke. We've had Jason Alexander.

We've had Kristen Stewart, just a wide variety of celebrities, Kurt Russell. Everybody's stopped by. Some people have left notes.

Some people have signed autographs and that sort of thing, and that's part of the memorabilia that's up here at the diner too that you get to experience. Fantastic. And how can people find you, Casey, online? Well, you can just go to PeggySuesDiner.com, or you can just search Peggy Sues Diner, and we should be one of the first ones that you see.

And there are not too many diners in Yermo, California, and especially not many that are called Peggy Sues Diner. You can't miss it. So everybody in Australia, if you're coming to LA and going to Las Vegas or vice versa, do drop in and see Casey and the team at the fantastic Peggy Sues.

Well, thank you very much, Tim. Thank you.